

Reconstructing Rashīdī manuscript production: the case for a Baghdad scriptorium

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Rashīd al-Dīn (d. 1318) left very specific instruction for how his scholarly works, including the historical compendium, the *Collected Histories* (*Jāmi' al-tawārīkh*), were to be reproduced and distributed. However, these plans were disrupted by his fall from grace and execution. Several partial manuscripts of the *Collected Histories* have survived from Rashīd al-Dīn's lifetime, but they do not match his instructions. This suggests that additional editorial processes shaped the early production of the text. This article compares the earliest manuscripts of the *Collected Histories* and the evidence surrounding Rashīd al-Dīn's book production efforts to better understand the origins of the main manuscripts used in modern editions of his history of the Mongols. This is made possible by the recent reemergence of a previously unstudied manuscript that helps fill in the lacunae of its source manuscript. This new manuscript, part of the collection of the Aga Khan, has never been used in any edition of Rashīd al-Dīn's history of the Mongols, but it offers great promise in reconstructing the early form of the work. Using that manuscript, this article presents the hypothesis that a group of scholars edited the *Collected Histories* at a scriptorium in Baghdad in the second decade of the fourteenth century. This may in turn help explain the appearance of certain seemingly contradictory textual additions made to the *Collected Histories* during the last years of Rashīd al-Dīn's lifetime.

Keywords: Rashīd al-Dīn, ghāzāniyya, Baghdad, manuscript production, Mongol history, Persian historiography, Jāmi' al-tawārīkh

The *Collected Histories* (*Jāmi' al-tawārīkh*) of Rashīd al-Dīn (d. 1318 CE) is probably the best known work produced at the court of the Ilkhans, the Mongol dynasty that ruled Iran from 1256 until 1335. Commissioned in two stages by the Ilkhan brothers Ghāzān (1295-1304) and Öljeitü (1304-1316), the collection contains two volumes: a dynastic history of the Mongols called the *Blessed History of Ghāzān* (*Tārīkh-i mubārak-i ghāzānī*), and a history of the known world. With the wealth that he gained from the *Collected Histories* and other projects completed for his Mongol patrons, Rashīd al-Dīn established a series of charitable endowments across the Ilkhanid realm where, among other things, scribes worked to produce copies of

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various works, including the *Collected Histories*. It is in part due to these efforts at self-promotion that Rashīd al-Dīn's history has survived the centuries since his death.¹

Just as the *Collected Histories* is the best known Ilkhanid work, its early manuscript witnesses, prepared at Rashīd al-Dīn's endowed scriptoria, are among the most recognisable artefacts in the study and publication of Iranian history during the Mongol period. Of these, the most famous by far is found in two fragments in the collections of the Edinburgh University Library (MS Or. 20) and Nasser Khalili (MS 727). These fragments provoked a sensation when they were identified in the 1830s as two parts of the same copy, and they have remained a landmark in the study of Persian book art ever since.² In late 2022, an adjunct art history instructor at Hamline University in Minnesota was summarily fired for showing an image of the Prophet Muhammad from this manuscript in class, triggering a significant controversy within American academia.³

The manuscript that has had the most impact on the textual reception of the *Collected Histories*, however, contains no images, even though it was formatted to receive at least forty-eight of them. It is a nearly complete copy of the *Blessed History* currently in the collection of the Topkapı Saray Museum in Istanbul, catalogue number R.1518. It was copied in Baghdad in the fall of 1317, less than a year before Rashīd al-Dīn's death, and is therefore the earliest dated copy of the *Blessed History*. Its claim to be the most important witness to the text derives from its secure and early provenance, its nearly complete condition, and its relative lack of scribal errors. This makes it the natural choice as a base text for the work, and it was selected as such by Muḥammad Rawshan and Muṣṭafā Mūsavī for their edition of 1994.⁴ In that edition, Rawshan and Mūsavī make regular reference to a second early manuscript, now in Tashkent (Abu Rayhon Beruni Institute, MS 1620), to fill in gaps in the 1317 Baghdad manuscript.

One striking fact that has gone largely uncommented is that the manuscript now in Tashkent and the corresponding folios of the Baghdad manuscript are near doppelgängers of one another, exhibiting exactly the same dimensions, the same number of lines per page, and the same formatting for illustrations and section headers. Indeed, more often than not these two manuscripts contain precisely the same passages of text on each page, often down to the individual word. In the world of manuscript production, before printing or even standardised manufacture of scribal tools, finding two such nearly identical manuscripts suggests a remarkable level of coordination in their production. In this case, we know exactly when and where one book was copied, but not the other. If we were dealing with anyone

1 For a thorough examination of Rashīd al-Dīn's endowment activities as part of his effort to preserve his own historical memory, see Hoffmann, *Waqf im mongolischen Iran*.

2 This manuscript has been most thoroughly treated by Blair, *A Compendium of Chronicles*.

3 The controversial image depicts Muhammad receiving revelation from the archangel Gabriel (Edinburgh University Library, MS Or. 20, fol. 45b). The decision to show it in class initially cost Erika López Prater her job. Dr. López Prater's dismissal subsequently led Hamline faculty to request the resignation of their president, Fayneese S. Miller, who instead announced her retirement. Christiane Gruber, who spearheaded the academic defence of Dr. López Prater, has since produced an online discussion of the manuscript and its images of Muhammad; see Gruber, *Jamī' al-tawārikh*.

4 Rashīd al-Dīn, *Jamī' al-tawārikh*, ed. Rawshan and Mūsavī, hereafter JT/RM.

other than Rashīd al-Dīn, this would be a dead giveaway that these manuscripts were products of the same scriptorium and that the manuscript now in Tashkent should also be linked to late Ilkhanid Baghdad.

But we are dealing with Rashīd al-Dīn.⁵ In the endowment deed for the Rashīdī Quarter (*rabʿ-i rashīdī*), his main complex of charitable and scholarly institutions outside the Mongol capital of Tabriz, Rashīd al-Dīn famously provided strict instructions for the reproduction of his own works, as discussed below. This opens the possibility that the 1317 Baghdad copy of the *Blessed History* and the undated copy now in Tashkent might have been produced in nearly identical form in isolation from one another. On the other hand, Rashīd al-Dīn's instructions stipulate that Arabic copies of his works were to be distributed to Arabic-speaking cities and Persian copies to Persian-speaking cities. The idea that one – and possibly two – Persian-language copies of the *Blessed History* were produced in Baghdad, a predominantly Arabic-speaking city, seems to defy the very instructions that might otherwise explain the similarity between them.⁶

In short, when trying to reconstruct the early production of the *Blessed History*, we face a dilemma. Either the 1317 Baghdad manuscript and the manuscript now in Tashkent were part of Rashīd al-Dīn's plan for the reproduction of his works, or they were not. If they were, then why was one, and possibly a second, Persian copy produced in Arabic-speaking Baghdad? If they were not part of Rashīd al-Dīn's official programme of reproduction, then how are they so similar to one another that they are almost interchangeable? In either case, why do two otherwise identical manuscripts diverge from one another in a few isolated yet significant instances? The aim of this article is to examine the evidence for the production of Rashīdī manuscripts – defined as manuscripts of Rashīd al-Dīn's work, produced during his lifetime in scriptoria established or managed by him – to consider how closely manuscripts made in the second city of the Ilkhanate matched their author's instructions. The focus here is on the historical *Jāmiʿ al-tawārīkh*, though copies of Rashīd al-Dīn's theological writings will be considered in so far as they contribute to the discussion.

In the absence of its colophon, several possibilities exist for the origin of the manuscript now in Tashkent, any of which carries remarkable implications. It may have been produced at Rashīd al-Dīn's central scriptorium at Tabriz, in which case it is the only copy of the *Blessed History* produced there known to have survived. From Tabriz, it may have been sent (incomplete, as the illustrations were never added) to Baghdad or to a different city. If it was sent to Baghdad, a Persian copy sent to an Arabic city, it may have been a source for the copy made there in 1317. In that case, the few but significant differences between the two manuscripts demand an exploration of what the copyists in Baghdad were up to, in light of Rashīd al-Dīn's strict reproduction instructions. If it was not sent to Baghdad, or if it was produced in a city other than Tabriz or Baghdad, then the close similarities in the formatting of the manuscript

5 My thanks to Sheila Blair, who consulted on this project before and after the Vienna conference (*pers. comm.*, 30 November and 2 December 2022) and who deserves credit for such a clear articulation of the unique factors that must be considered when dealing with Rashīdī manuscripts.

6 On Baghdad as a predominantly Arabic-speaking city, where mainly Arabic books were produced, see Bruno De Nicola's contribution to this volume.

in Tashkent and the 1317 Baghdad manuscript suggest a remarkable level of copy control across Rashīd al-Dīn's network of scriptoria. We know that Rashīd al-Dīn was interested in Chinese block printing, and elsewhere I have argued that his obsessive instructions for precise reproduction of his works reflect a desire to approach the precision that block printing made possible.⁷ If the manuscript in Tashkent was produced in isolation from the 1317 Baghdad copy, it would show that he succeeded.

This article may not provide definitive conclusions, and a reader may reasonably disagree with the hypotheses raised here. The effort of mustering evidence from textual and material sources, including a previously unknown manuscript of the *Blessed History*, should at least shed some light on the messy reality that resulted from Rashīd al-Dīn's careful prescriptions for the reproduction of his own works. Taken together, this evidence allows us to reasonably posit a group of scholars, including the librarian and biographer Ibn al-Fuwaṭī (1244-1323), the scribe Rashīd Khwāfī (active c. 1290-1310), and the latter's son Mubārakshāh (active c. 1317), working in Ghāzān Khān's endowed madrasa in Baghdad to produce an early edited version of the *Collected Histories*.

This article is structured around three contexts for understanding the 1317 Baghdad manuscript: first, the context of the 1994 edition by Rawshan and Mūsavī; then the context of related manuscripts, including a previously unstudied copy in the collection of the Aga Khan; and finally the context of Rashīd al-Dīn's instructions for manuscript reproduction. This last context is explored through three bodies of evidence from manuscript studies, including secondary testimony by Ibn al-Fuwaṭī about the people involved in the production of Rashīdī manuscripts. The final section offers one interpretation for untangling this evidence to explain how the two manuscripts at the centre of this study can be nearly identical yet different in a few important ways.

The 1994 edition of the Blessed History

The 1317 Baghdad copy of the *Blessed History* is mostly complete: the first and sixth folios are missing, the surviving opening pages are out of order, and there are several short internal lacunae that may simply be attributed to scribal error.⁸ Otherwise, it contains the entirety of the text, in a format that probably reflects Rashīd al-Dīn's final vision for the *Blessed History*, which I have elsewhere labelled the ζ recension.⁹

7 Kamola, *Making Mongol History*, 140-142.

8 The first six folios of the manuscript in its current form were fols. 7, 8, and 2-5 in the original book.

9 Kamola, *Making Mongol History*, 138-140, 222-225.

Hypothetical foliation	JT/RM page numbers	Tashkent manuscript	Aga Khan manuscript	Baghdad manuscript
1	A1a-b	Missing	1	Missing
2	1, 2	1	2	3
3	3, 4	4	3	4
4	5, 6	5	4	5
5	7, 8	Missing	5	6
6	9, 10, A10b	3	6	Missing
7	A11a, 11	2	7	1
8	12, 13	Missing	8	2
9	14, 15	Missing	9	7
10	16, 17	6	10	8

Figure 1: Hypothetical reconstruction of the opening folios of the Blessed History. Hypothetical foliation on the left is compared to the numbering of Rawshan and Mūsavī (JT/RM) and the surviving folios of three main manuscripts. The Baghdad and Tashkent manuscript have been used for the edition, with passages supplied from Mashhad, Āstān-e Qods Razavi, MS 4101 (JT/RM manuscript A, represented by folio numbers in the format A1a). The complete state of the Aga Khan manuscript (from which the Āstān-e Qods manuscript was copied) makes it a preferable source for this portion of text.

In their edition of the *Blessed History*, Rawshan and Mūsavī correct the errors of the Baghdad manuscript by reference to the undated copy in Tashkent. The Tashkent manuscript is also a very early copy, and it preserves several short passages that seem to have been dropped from the 1317 Baghdad copy through scribal error. However, the manuscript in Tashkent contains numerous lacunae, limiting its usefulness as a base text. The largest lacuna is of approximately the last one-fifth of its original pages, meaning there is no colophon providing a date or place of production.¹⁰ Since the Tashkent manuscript also lacks some of its opening pages, the editors further rely on a related manuscript in Mashhad (Āstān-e Qods Razavi, MS 4101).¹¹ (See Figure 1 for a concordance of the extant opening folios of the Baghdad manuscript, the manuscript now in Tashkent, and the Aga Khan manuscript described below.)

We know that Rawshan and Mūsavī's main manuscript was made in Baghdad in late 1317 because its colophon has survived. (See appendix for the text and translation of this and related colophons discussed below.) It is not signed – a fact to which we will return – though the copyist identifies himself in a note added to the text of the *Blessed History* as Mubārakshāh b. Rashīd Khwāfī.¹² The final line of the colophon provides the date and location for the copying of the manuscript. The bulk of the colophon, however, describes how the *Collected Histories* took shape. Much of this is familiar from the description that Rashīd al-Dīn himself offers in

10 For more on the Tashkent manuscript in the reception of the *Jāmi' al-tawārikh*, see Kamola, *Editing Rashid*.

11 The manuscript in Mashhad is descended from the Tashkent manuscript via the copy now in the collection of the Aga Khan, which is the focus of a later section of this article.

12 Istanbul, Topkapı Saray Müzesi, MS R.1518, fol. 251a.

his general introduction to the work: a dynastic history, the *Blessed History of Ghāzān*, was prepared on the instruction of Ghāzān Khān, and a second volume was added under the instruction of Ghāzān's brother and successor Öljeitü, which included a history of the world and of his own reign.¹³ No extant copy of the second volume includes the history of Öljeitü, and there has been some discussion as to what shape it would have taken.¹⁴ The colophon of the Baghdad manuscript, however, would have us believe that Rashīd al-Dīn ended up appending the history of Öljeitü from volume two to the end of volume one for the convenience of readers and copyists who might not have access to the full *Collected Histories*.

Indeed, the colophon of the Baghdad manuscript is followed by at least one and a half manuscript pages of text about the accession of Öljeitü. This begins at the top of fol. 342a with a header for the “beginning of the *dāstān* of the Pādishāh of Islam, Öljeitü Sultan, may his kingship be eternal”. Near the top of the verso, a section header announces the “account of the gathering of the royal banners and the blessed accession of the Pādishāh of Islam – may his kingship be eternal – to the throne of the sultanate”. The beginning of the text of this section occupies the top half of the page. The bottom has been formatted for an image.¹⁵

It seems that the author of the colophon has interpreted this short text as an accommodation on the part of Rashīd al-Dīn, calling it an addendum (*dhayl*) and an inclusion (*dākhel*) of text that originally formed part of the second volume of the *Collected Histories*.¹⁶ However, Rashīd al-Dīn's table of contents for the *Blessed History* suggests that such a section of text was originally intended as part of the dynastic history. In the Baghdad manuscript, and in most manuscripts of the work, the table of contents for the volume ends with an entry for the “*dāstān* of the blessed accession of the Shahanshāh of Islam, Öljeitü Sultan”.¹⁷ In the main witness to the earliest extant version of the text, however, this entry in the table of contents announces the “*tārīkh* of the blessed accession of the Shahanshāh of Islam, Sultan Muḥammad Khudābanda Khān”.¹⁸ This can be considered the original header for the section on three grounds. First, it is included in the earliest surviving recension of the text. Second, it is designated as a *tārīkh* instead of a full *dāstān*, marking it as different from the three-part *dāstāns* that Rashīd al-Dīn provides for royal Mongols from Dobun Bayan to Ghāzān Khān. Finally, it

13 For Rashīd al-Dīn's description of the two-stage commission, see JT/RM 1, 8–9; Thackston, *Rashiduddin*, 3, 6–7; Thackston, *Classical Writings*, 1, 3. For a new assessment of how the world history took shape and became part of the collection, see Kamola, The first draft.

14 The life and reign of Öljeitü is best known from 'Abd Allāh Qāshānī, *Tārīkh-i Uljaitu*, ed. Hambly. Recent scholarship has substantiated Qāshānī's claims that Rashīd al-Dīn appropriated his work for much of the rest of the World History: Otsuka, Qāshānī; Kamola, Salghurid history. It may be that the *Tārīkh-i Uljaitu* was at one point intended as part of the *Collected Histories*.

15 For this study, only a microfilm scan of the Baghdad manuscript was available. It is therefore unknown if this narrative continues on further pages. Another manuscript, London, BL, MS Add. 16688 (discussed below), fols. 291b–293a, contains a slightly extended version of the same text.

16 The colophon does not name Rashīd al-Dīn, and the word translated here as author, *muṣannaf*, could also be read as “scribe”. However, the inclusion of the supplication “*azza naṣruhu*” indicates that Rashīd al-Dīn is meant. The version of this same colophon found in Toronto, MS AKM 517 (discussed below) includes the same supplication also when referring to the *muṣannaf* at the start of the colophon.

17 Istanbul, TSM, MS R.1518, fol. 6a; cf. London, BL, MS Add. 7628, fol. 408b; Tehran, Majles, MS 2294, fol. 5a.

18 Munich, BSB, MS Cod. Pers. 207, fol. 80b.

uses Öljeitü's pre-sultanic name Khudābanda Khān, indicating it was written contemporary with or shortly after his coronation. We would expect such a section to look much like the passage that survives at the end of the Baghdad manuscript: a short account of Khudābanda's accession, rather than a full narrative of the life and reign of Öljeitü Sultan, which was only envisioned later as part of the second volume of the *Collected Histories*.

The text found after the colophon of the Baghdad manuscript – or something like it – should therefore be considered as an integral part of the *Blessed History*. Textually, it is related to the description of Khudābanda's coronation found in the general introduction to the *Collected Histories*, and it was probably written in the interval between the death of Ghāzān in May 1304 and the presentation of the *Blessed History* to Khudābanda Öljeitü that fall, before the new Ilkhan gave instructions for the second volume. The colophon from 1317 in the Baghdad manuscript therefore deviates from the table of contents when it calls the text about Öljeitü's accession an addendum and insertion from the second volume into the first. It also deviates by describing the *Collected Histories* as a two-volume work, making no mention of a third volume described in the table of contents. That would have been a world gazetteer which, like the history of Öljeitü's reign planned for the second volume, has not survived.¹⁹

In short, the manuscript made in Baghdad in the fall of 1317 seems on the whole to present Rashīd al-Dīn's final vision for the *Blessed History*, and it has been treated as such by editors. However, its colophon strongly suggests that its scribe did not understand the form originally intended for the *Blessed History* and adjusted his description of the work accordingly, calling the *tārīkh* of Öljeitü's coronation an inclusion from volume two and entirely ignoring volume three, which had been promised but not completed. This incongruity can be explained if we consider the Baghdad manuscript as the product of a secondary editorial process conducted late in Rashīd al-Dīn's life by scholars outside his direct supervision. To arrive at that conclusion, however, first requires a close comparison of the Baghdad manuscript with the manuscript now in Tashkent. That comparison is facilitated by the recent appearance of a previously unknown copy of the Tashkent manuscript.

The Aga Khan manuscript and the question of copy control

As already mentioned, the Baghdad manuscript and the copy now in Tashkent are very similar to one another. Each is formatted with a written surface of 34 × 24 cm, and copied in a very clear *naskh* script with 29 lines of text per page. Throughout, the two manuscripts align very closely in their headers, spaces for images, formatting of genealogical trees, and even the specific portions of text per page. The lacunae of the Tashkent manuscript have previously made a thorough comparison impossible. However, the recent reappearance of another manuscript allows us to better appreciate the measures taken to align these manuscripts with a specific layout for the *Blessed History* and, therefore, with one another.

19 But see Kamola, The first draft, for the idea that the gazetteer was originally envisioned as part of the world history.

The new manuscript is part of the collection of the Aga Khan, accessioned to the Aga Khan Museum in Toronto as MS AKM 517.²⁰ Prior to being auctioned in October 2000, the manuscript had never come to the attention of scholars working with the *Blessed History*. It contains no date or place of copy, though it includes a variation of the colophon found in the 1317 Baghdad copy, to which we will return. Based on the style of its opening illumination, the manuscript can be linked to the court of the Timurid ruler Shāhrukh (1405-1447).²¹ The Aga Khan manuscript contains 344 folios, currently of 37 × 27 cm, but trimmed down from larger original sheets. These have been numbered in Arabic numerals by the page, rather than the folio. (For folio numbers given below, p. 1 equates to fol. 1b.) The written surface measures about 29 × 20 cm, with 29 lines of very good *naskh* per page, in several hands. Headers are written in gold, blue, red, and occasionally yellow. The latter half of the manuscript is disordered.

The Aga Khan manuscript is demonstrably a copy of the defective early copy now in Tashkent. For its entire length, it exhibits precise fidelity to the page and even line breaks of the Tashkent manuscript, with identical formatting of headers, genealogical trees, and spaces for illustrations. In several places the manuscripts share lacunae, such as the missing family tree of Chaghadaï. The most definitive evidence establishing this as a copy of the manuscript in Tashkent is the fact that, in at least two places, the Aga Khan manuscript reproduces lacunae that resulted from damage done to the Tashkent manuscript. On fols. 50a and 65a there appear empty square spaces where the last half of nine consecutive lines of text should be. On the opposite side of the sheet from each of these spaces one finds space for the image of a Mongol ruler and his wife attached to the genealogical tree showing their descendants.²² These same two images have been cut out of the manuscript in Tashkent, leaving holes in the pages that were later repaired.²³

The Aga Khan manuscript was evidently copied after these images were cut out of the Tashkent manuscript and before it was repaired, when square holes were missing from the folios. A third instance where this might have been the case (MS AKM 517, fol. 56) cannot be verified, as the corresponding page in the Tashkent manuscript is now lost. Of eight missing folios of the Aga Khan manuscript, six correspond to pages that would have contained genealogical trees. Of these, two are missing from the Tashkent manuscript and two others are represented there by replacement folios. These four may have never been part of the Aga Khan

20 For general information on this manuscript, see Kamola, *Making Mongol History*, 223-224, where the correct order of folios is given, though the typographical error “1-27” should be read as “1-327”, and two folios are missing after page 335, instead of one; see also <https://collections.agakhanmuseum.org/collection/artifact/jami-al-tavarikh-tarikh-i-mubarak-i-ghazani-the-blessed-history-of-ghazan-akm517>.

21 Christie’s, Rashid al-Din Fadlullah; Ilse Sturkenboom, *pers. comm.*, 29 May 2024.

22 These are Dobun Bayan on fol. 50b and Bartan Bahadur on fol. 65b.

23 Tashkent, Abu Rayhon Beruni Institute, MS 1620, fol. 25b (Dobun Bayan) and fol. 49b (Bartan Bahadur). Two such original images remain *in situ* in the Tashkent manuscript: those of Ögödei and Boraqchin (fol. 108b) and of Hülegü and Doquz (fol. 190b). Other Ilkhanid examples of these enthronement scenes can be found in the Diez Albums; Kadoi, *The Mongols enthroned*, 269-275. There is no reason to suspect that any of the images found in the Diez Albums were taken from the Tashkent manuscript, as they contain no evidence of text on their reverse side.

manuscript when it was copied. Discounting the missing genealogical trees, the only text definitively missing from the Aga Khan manuscript are two folios from the third *qism* of the *dāstān* of Ghāzān Khān.²⁴ Nine other folios (218-226) are later replacement pages, in a finer, smaller hand. In this case, the original eleven folios of the Tashkent manuscript (211-221) have survived, making direct comparison possible between it and the Baghdad manuscript.

Clearly, then, the Aga Khan manuscript preserves more of the text than its source. It is, in fact, the most complete copy from the ζ recension preferred for editions of the text. While some portraits of Mongol rulers had already been cut out, the Tashkent copy apparently suffered its most significant damage after the Aga Khan copy was made. As a result, the Aga Khan manuscript can serve as a surrogate for its source manuscript when comparing it to the manuscript made in Baghdad in 1317. Here again the correspondence is almost exact, with large portions of the two manuscripts aligning page for page, line for line, and even word for word. In a few places, the manuscripts fall out of sync with one another, but they always end up coming back into alignment.

For example, the material of fifteen folios in the Tashkent (fols. 19-33) and Aga Khan manuscripts (fols. 24-38) is squeezed onto twelve folios of the Baghdad manuscript (fols. 22-33). Later, 39 folios in the Aga Khan manuscript (fols. 237-257 and 282-298, plus one folio missing after fol. 242) correspond to 31 folios in the Baghdad copy (fols. 263-293). In both cases, the folios before and after these misaligned sections correspond exactly to one another. (See Figure 2 for details on the alignment of the Tashkent, Aga Khan, and Baghdad manuscripts.)

The most interesting case of how these manuscripts are kept in sync with one another concerns the ancestors of Chinggis Khan. This section contains the only significant textual variation between the 1317 copy from Baghdad, on the one hand, and the Aga Khan manuscript, on the other. (A large lacuna in the Tashkent manuscript makes it impossible to include it in this comparison.) Unlike the Aga Khan manuscript, the 1317 Baghdad manuscript contains a one-page story of the abduction of Hambaqai Khan, the Mongol ruler two generations before Chinggis Khan, whose abduction by the Tatars and execution by the Jurchen Jin provided a *casus belli* for subsequent Mongol campaigns. In several places, Rashīd al-Dīn gives brief encapsulations of the story, but it appears in full only in the 1317 Baghdad copy and other manuscripts closely related to it.²⁵ To add just this, however, would put the Baghdad manuscript out of sync with the others by exactly one page, or half of a folio. To correct for this, the text and diagrams on the adjacent folios are copied more sparsely in the Baghdad manuscript than in the Aga Khan, with extra space given for headers and genealogical trees. (See Figure 2 for the location of this variant.) In the end, after six folios in the Baghdad manuscript (fols. 47-52) and five in the Aga Khan manuscript (fols. 52-56), the two come once again into alignment with one another.

Clearly, then, there was significant control exercised over the production of these manuscripts to make sure that they adhered to a particular model and, when they deviated from that model, that they quickly realigned with it. Given that the 1317 Baghdad manuscript

24 This lacuna falls between fols. 318 and 319 in the manuscript and corresponds to fols. 308 and 309 of Istanbul, TSM, MS R.1518 (*JT/RM*, 1392-1401).

25 On this alternate abduction narrative, see Kamola, *The poppy and the mulberry*.

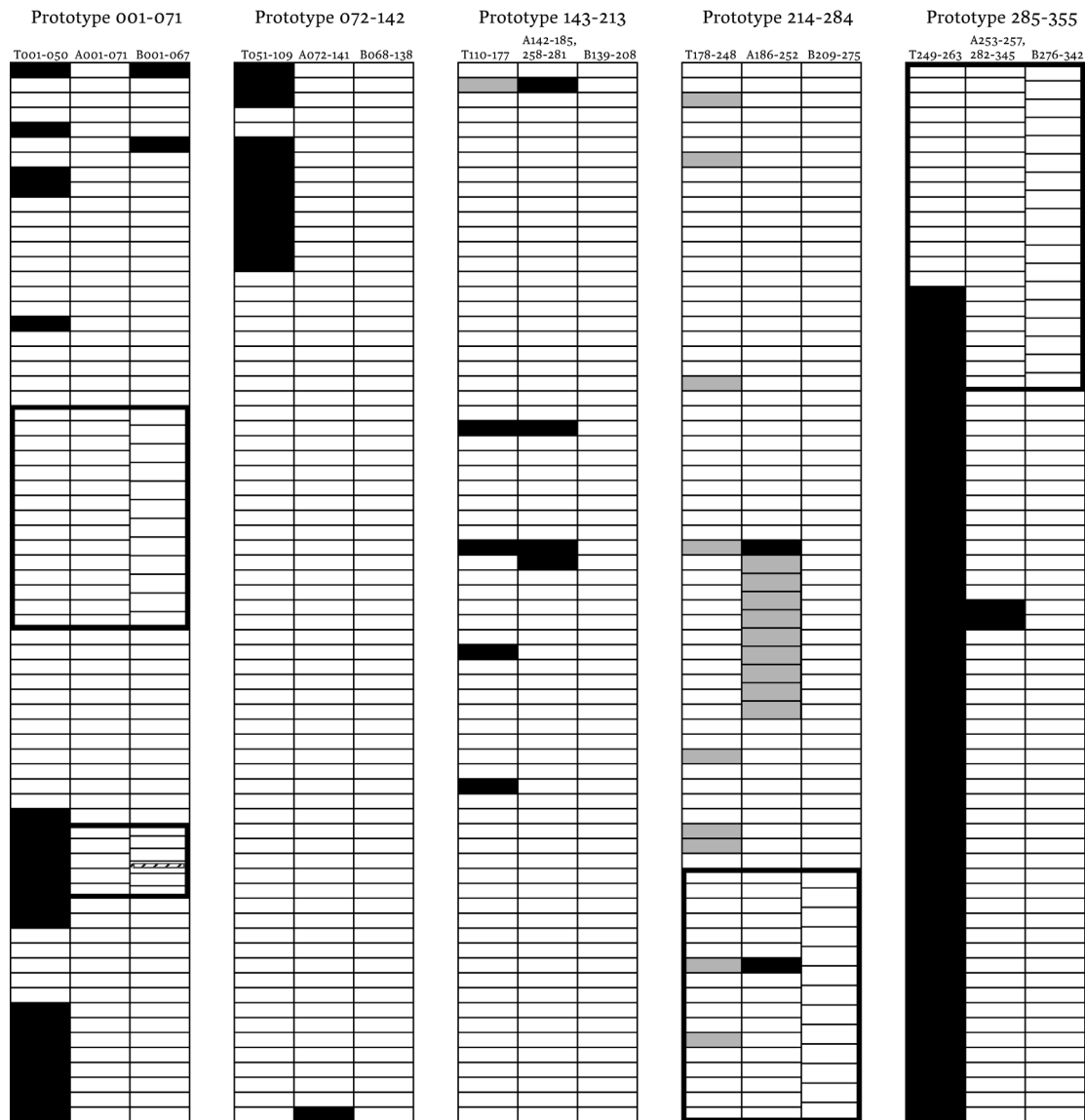


Figure 2: Hypothetical reconstruction of ζ -recension manuscripts. Each column represents a manuscript: Tashkent (T), Aga Khan (A), and Baghdad (B). Each cell represents one folio. Lacunae are shaded black; replacement pages are shaded grey. Sections of misalignment are outlined in bold. The section containing the story of Hambaqai Khan found in the Baghdad manuscript is marked in diagonal lines in the lower part of the first column.

and the one now in Tashkent also have the same dimensions, this kind of alignment, for any other text by any other author, would immediately suggest that the two manuscripts were produced at the same scriptorium, where the same scribes used the same paper and the same tools to prepare and copy from a single exemplar.²⁶ However, we know that Rashīd al-Dīn

²⁶ There is still very little scholarship on individual scriptoria. For an example, though, of how format correlates to an individual atelier – in this case to the Tabriz scriptorium of Rashīd al-Dīn – see Blair, *Calligraphers*,

took extraordinary measures to prescribe the reproduction of his own texts at the Rashīdī Quarter. The question facing us, then, is whether the controls that kept these two early manuscripts in sync with one another were part of Rashīd al-Dīn's Tabriz-based reproduction programme, or were instead part of a local project in Baghdad, where we know at least one of them was made.

Whichever way we answer this question carries interesting implications. If Rashīd al-Dīn's reproduction instructions could lead to nearly identical manuscripts being reproduced in different places, then we could probably use the Baghdad, Tashkent, and Aga Khan manuscripts to reconstruct the form of the *Blessed History* as it was produced at the Rashīdī Quarter. If, on the other hand, the Tashkent manuscript is seen as the product of the same atelier that produced the manuscript with the colophon linking it to Baghdad, then we are left searching for a specific scriptorium where these manuscripts would have been made and a reason for the few but significant deviations that do distinguish them from one another, such as the addition of the story of Hambaqai Khan. Revisiting the terms of Rashīd al-Dīn's reproduction programme, alongside evidence from the writing of Ibn al-Fuwaṭī and from other surviving manuscripts from the period allows us to hypothesise such a scriptorium in northern Baghdad where the *Collected Histories* was edited and reproduced by scholars inspired by, but acting independently of, Rashīd al-Dīn's instructions.

Rashīd al-Dīn's plans for manuscript reproduction

We can state confidently that Rashīd al-Dīn asserted strict controls over the reproduction of his works, since his own instructions in this regard have survived. They are found in the text of the endowment deed (Ar. *waqfiyya*, Pers. *waqfnāme*) for the Rashīdī Quarter.²⁷ However, based on the dating of the earliest manuscripts and the testimony of Ibn al-Fuwaṭī (discussed below), it is clear that this centralised reproduction project began even before the endowment deed was written. Building on the work of Sheila Blair, Nourane Ben Azzouna has reconstructed a three-stage development of Rashīd al-Dīn's instructions for manuscript production at the Rashīdī Quarter.²⁸ The first phase, included in the original endowment deed of 1309, calls only for the reproduction of manuscripts of the Qur'ān and the *ḥadīth* collection of Majd al-Dīn Ibn al-Athīr (1149-1210). An appendix to the endowment was added between late 1309 and 1311, and a second was added later, probably in early 1314.

In each of these appendices, Rashīd al-Dīn expands the list of books to be copied to include various titles of his own, including his historical compendium and several theological and scientific collections. According to the first appendix, four of Rashīd al-Dīn's works were to be copied in Arabic and Persian and distributed to madrasas in the major cities of the Ilkhanate according to the predominant language spoken in each: Arabic copies to Arabic-speaking

illuminators and painters, 176-177.

27 The endowment deed has been published in facsimile and in typographical edition; Rashīd al-Dīn, *al-Waqfiyya al-rashīdiyya*, 1972 (facsimile) and 1977 (type), ed. Mīnuvī and Afshār.

28 Ben Azzouna, *Aux origines du classicisme*, 296-332; Ben Azzouna, Rashīd al-Dīn Faḍl Allāh; developing on Blair, *Writing and illustrating history*.

cities and Persian copies to Persian-speaking cities.²⁹ These copies were to be available to loan out to individuals to copy for their own use. Within the Rashīdī Quarter, several of the same works (the *Collected Histories* excepted) were to be taught and scholars supported by the endowment were required to make copies for their own use.

The second appendix expands the number of works to be copied as well as the scale of reproduction.³⁰ Notably, Rashīd al-Dīn stipulates that, in addition to the production of deluxe exemplars at the main endowment in Tabriz, all his works, including his historical, theological, and scientific collections, were to be copied through the practice of simultaneous dictation there and at twenty other sites throughout the Ilkhanate. Each site was to work according to a rotating seven-year schedule, so that three full copies were produced in the realm each year.

Several copies of Rashīd al-Dīn's theological and historical works have survived from Rashīd al-Dīn's centralised manuscript production project, so we know the format and production quality of manuscripts made under his direction. Even before he instructed the Rashīdī Quarter to reproduce his works, the Persian and Arabic exemplars of his theological collection, the *Majmu'a-i rashīdī*, had been produced, possibly at a mobile scriptorium attached to the itinerant royal court.³¹ A copy of the Arabic *Majmu'a* includes a colophon linking its production to the Rashīdī Quarter in 1311 or 1312, after the first appendix was added to the endowment deed.³² At least three partial copies of the world history from the second volume of the *Collected Histories* can also be linked to the Tabriz scriptorium.³³

In addition to their deluxe illumination and, in the case of the historical works, their illustration, all of these manuscripts were produced in the same format, with a written surface of 37 × 26 cm. Each of them is copied in 35 lines per page except the earliest, the Persian *Majmu'a-i rashīdī*, which has 33 lines per page.³⁴ Presumably these represent the format of the exemplars from which copies were made for distribution and which were used for copy-

29 Rashīd al-Dīn, *al-Waqfiyya al-rashīdiyya*, 1972, ed. Mīnuvī and Afshār, 293-296; 1977, ed. Mīnuvī and Afshār, 237-241; summarised by Ben Azzouna, *Aux origines du classicisme*, 296-298; Ben Azzouna, Rashīd al-Dīn Faḍl Allāh, 192-193.

30 Rashīd al-Dīn, *al-Waqfiyya al-rashīdiyya*, 1972, ed. Mīnuvī and Afshār, 325-344; 1977, ed. Mīnuvī and Afshār, 241-252; summarised by Ben Azzouna, *Aux origines du classicisme*, 299-323; Ben Azzouna, Rashīd al-Dīn Faḍl Allāh, 193-197.

31 These are Tehran, Golestan, MS 2235 (the Persian exemplar, dated 5 May 1309) and Paris, BnF, MS Arabe 2324 (the Arabic exemplar, copied between 1307 and 1310); Ben Azzouna, *Aux origines du classicisme*, 333. Ben Azzouna, *Aux origines du classicisme*, 295, follows Shimo, Three manuscripts, in suggesting that an undated copy of the *Blessed History* was also produced under these circumstances. Elsewhere I have argued that this is an early Timurid copy; Kamola, *Making Mongol History*, 219-220.

32 Doha, MIA, 6/1998.

33 The Arabic copy dated to 1314 (now divided between Edinburgh University Library, MS 20, and the Nasser Khalili Collection, MS 727) and parts of a Persian copy (also dated 1314, later reconstructed by Ḥāfīz-i Abrū and now in Istanbul, TSM, H.1653) contain colophons linking them to the Rashīdī scriptorium in Tabriz. By comparison, fragments from another copy have been attributed to the Rashīdī Quarter. Those fragments are now divided between Istanbul, TSM, H.1653, and another similarly reconstructed manuscript that has since been dispersed. On the Persian fragments and their reconstructions, see Ghiasian, *Lives of the Prophets*, 81-91.

34 An additional deluxe manuscript of the Persian world history with 35 lines per page was presumably lost in the fire that destroyed the library of the Nawabs of Awadh in Lucknow in 1857.

ing by dictation at the Rashīdī Quarter. Also, given the fact that multiple copies of the Arabic theological works and the Persian world history have survived, this may have been the format of copies distributed to regional madrasas, where they would have become the exemplars used for subsequent recopying.

Of course, the survival of Rashīd al-Dīn's instructions to reproduce his works, of the exemplars, and of a few copies made from them does not mean that his full manuscript reproduction plans were ever realised. Rashīd al-Dīn was a man of grand ideas, many of which came late in his life and were never carried through to completion. He fell out of favour and was executed in 1318, just a few years after writing his second appendix to the endowment deed that lays out the full programme for book production. Thus, there would not have been time to complete the seven-year cycle of reproduction at the regional scriptoria before his fall from grace, even if those centres were fully equipped and staffed and had copies of the works on hand to be copied at the moment the appendix was drafted. Those exemplars would have first had to be produced at the Rashīdī Quarter according to the processes laid out in the first appendix, and even if that was carried out to the letter, only a handful of copies in Arabic and the same number in Persian would have been circulated to other cities. Rashīd al-Dīn's final wishes for the mass reproduction of his own works could never have reached the scale he intended.

Rashīdī manuscript reproduction outside of Tabriz: three bodies of evidence

Evidence does suggest, however, that even during his lifetime, some degree of copying and editing of Rashīd al-Dīn's works did occur outside of Tabriz. Other than the Persian and Arabic exemplars and the Arabic copy of the *Majmu'ā* already discussed, eleven copies of Rashīd al-Dīn's theological and scientific work survive from his lifetime.³⁵ Of these, only two preserve colophons giving their location of copy: one from the Ḥakamiyya madrasa in Ghāzān's foundation of Shanb in Tabriz, the other from the Ghāzāniyya madrasa in Baghdad. For the early historical manuscripts under consideration here, evidence comes from three sources. Taken together, these allow us to speculate on the activities of one regional scriptorium, possibly the Ghāzāniyya foundation in the north of Baghdad, as an active centre of editing and recopying the *Collected Histories* in the late Ilkhanate.

Exhibit A: Deluxe copies of the Collected Histories

Besides the manuscripts that can be confidently attributed to the Tabriz scriptorium, several extant copies of Rashīd al-Dīn's historical writings can be attributed to the Ilkhanid period, and even to the lifetime of the author. These exhibit different formats from the Tabriz copies, but similar formats to one another. Again recalling the lack of industrial standardisation in the production of paper or scribal tools, the appearance of manuscripts with the same dimensions of written surface and number of lines per page suggests that they were produced

35 Seven of these are catalogued by Ben Azzouna, *Aux origines du classicisme*, 579-589, numbers 65, 68, 70, 71, 73, 75, and 76. Unexamined by Ben Azzouna are St Petersburg, Institute of Oriental Manuscripts, MS 375; Tehran, Malek, MS 1281; Oxford, Bodleian, MS Pers. c. 35; and Islamabad, Ganj Baksh Library, MS 13789.

at the same workshop or that their production was coordinated in some other way. We cannot rule out the idea that Rashīd al-Dīn coordinated the format of manuscripts at the various locations in his network of scriptoria, which would have been a remarkable feat in its own right. Lacking any direct evidence that he did so, however, we can only speculate on why such close similarities exist between surviving early copies of the *Collected Histories*.

Returning to the manuscripts compared earlier in this article, the Baghdad manuscript and the manuscript now in Tashkent from which the Aga Khan copy was made exhibit the same *mise en page*: a written surface of 34×24 cm and 29 lines of text per page. This, as well as the clear efforts taken to keep the manuscripts in sync with one another on a page-by-page basis, suggests a shared place of origin. Given that they do not match the manuscripts known to have been made in Tabriz, this raises the very real possibility that the Tashkent manuscript was made in the same scriptorium as the copy dated 1317, and that both were copied in Baghdad from an exemplar sent there from Tabriz as part of the reproduction scheme laid out in the first appendix to the Rashīdī Quarter endowment deed. Rashīd al-Dīn does not specify which cities were to receive copies of his works and in what order, but Baghdad was second only to Tabriz in the political and cultural life of the Ilkhanate. If any city was to receive copies in the few years that the reproduction programme might have been in operation, the City of Peace must have been high on the list, if not at the top.

This picture is further complicated by the survival of two other manuscripts with similar dimensions to the Tashkent and Baghdad manuscripts, but with 31 rather than 29 lines per page. The first is the most complete copy of the Persian world history dated to Rashīd al-Dīn's lifetime, Istanbul, TSM, MS H.1654. Based on the quality of the few original illustrations that exist in this book, it has typically been ascribed to the Rashīdī Quarter in Tabriz.³⁶ However, there is no direct attestation to Tabriz in the manuscript, and its format is closer to that of the 1317 Baghdad copy of the *Blessed History* – sharing at least the written surface dimensions with that book – than it is to any Rashīdī manuscript known to have been produced in Tabriz. The second manuscript is Tehran, Golestan, MS 2234, a seemingly very early copy of the *Blessed History* also written in 31 lines per page, with a reported written surface of 35×23 cm.³⁷ The similarity between these two manuscripts hints at a shared provenance with one another, at least. That the dimensions of their written pages are similar to those of the Baghdad and Tashkent manuscripts leaves open the possibility that they, too, were copied in Baghdad, though they could also be productions of a separate Rashīdī scriptorium in another city of the realm.

The evidence from early manuscripts of the *Collected Histories*, then, is inconclusive, but it opens the possibility that the collection was copied in Baghdad (and perhaps at least one other regional scriptorium) in a format somewhat smaller than the one used in Tabriz. There remain the questions of why the 1317 Baghdad manuscript was copied in Persian, and why it exhibits small but significant textual variants from the manuscript now in Tashkent and its Aga Khan copy.

36 See most recently Ghiasian, Topkapı manuscript.

37 My thanks to Professor Ghasem Gharib for this information (*pers. comm.*, 18 June 2023).

Exhibit B: The testimony of Ibn al-Fuwaṭī

We owe a great deal of our understanding of Ilkhanid society to the biographical compendium of Kamāl al-Dīn Ibn al-Fuwaṭī, who worked as librarian in the Mustanṣariyya madrasa in Baghdad.³⁸ Ibn al-Fuwaṭī wrote short sketches of individuals from various walks of life whom he met through his work or while travelling, including on several trips to the capital region around Tabriz.³⁹ In doing so, he preserves information about several people involved in reproducing Rashīd al-Dīn's works. Famously, he mentions (entry no. 768) a certain 'Afīf al-Dīn al-Naqqash, whom he saw illuminating a book by Rashīd al-Dīn at Sultan Öljeitü's camp in Arran in 705 AH (1305-1306 CE).⁴⁰ Two other entries (nos. 3196 and 4156) mention individuals copying Rashīd al-Dīn's theological works in the capital region in 706 AH (1306-1307 CE) and another (no. 4047) names a third copyist, with no date or location given.⁴¹

A second group of individuals that Ibn al-Fuwaṭī names in relation to Rashīd al-Dīn are four scholars (nos. 101, 120, 1135, and 1386), including a lawyer and a scholar of *ḥadīth*, who were working at a madrasa that Rashīd al-Dīn had established within the Ghāzāniyya complex in Baghdad.⁴² Three of Ibn al-Fuwaṭī's meetings with these scholars are dated to the year 713 (1313-1314 CE), indicating that the madrasa was operating by the time that Rashīd al-Dīn wrote the final appendix to the endowment deed of the Rashīdī Quarter. The Ghāzāniyya foundation, established by Ghāzān Khān and subsequently put under Rashīd al-Dīn's supervision, is one of only a handful of locations that Rashīd al-Dīn specifically names among the twenty locations outside of Tabriz where copying of his works was to take place, and it is likely that his own madrasa would have been the site within the Ghāzāniyya where this would have happened.

Two additional notices by Ibn al-Fuwaṭī deserve special attention in that they contain references both to copying Rashīd al-Dīn's work and to the Ghāzāniyya in Baghdad. One of them (no. 4074) states that the pharmacist Majd al-Dīn Ismā'īl al-Baghdādī was copying Rashīd al-Dīn's works at the madrasa of the Ghāzāniyya in the year 713, and it further locates the madrasa (and by extension the entire Ghāzāniyya) near the Zafariyya gate.⁴³ This gate, also known as the Waṣṭānī or Khurāsān gate, was on the northeast side of the city and is one of the few sections of the medieval fortifications to survive to this day.⁴⁴

A final entry of particular note (no. 3814) concerns a certain Kamāl al-Dīn Musā al-Ardabīlī, whom Ibn al-Fuwaṭī met in 714 AH (1314-1315 CE) at the Sultan's madrasa of the Ghāzāniyya and whom he agreed to help with the collation of the *Collected Histories*.⁴⁵ Elsewhere, I have shown that Rashīd al-Dīn modified the text of the *Collected Histories*, and especially the

38 Ibn al-Fuwaṭī, *Talkhīṣ majma' al-ādāb*. Entry numbers here refer to the al-Kāẓim edition of 1995.

39 For an overview, see Melville, Ebn al-Fowaṭī.

40 Ibn al-Fuwaṭī, *Talkhīṣ majma' al-ādāb*, ed. al-Kāẓim, I.478.

41 Ibn al-Fuwaṭī, *Talkhīṣ majma' al-ādāb*, ed. al-Kāẓim, III.561-562, IV.436, IV.392.

42 Ibn al-Fuwaṭī, *Talkhīṣ majma' al-ādāb*, ed. al-Kāẓim, I.131-132, I.146, II.109, II.233.

43 Ibn al-Fuwaṭī, *Talkhīṣ majma' al-ādāb*, ed. al-Kāẓim, IV.403.

44 For more on the Waṣṭānī gate in the urban fabric of medieval Baghdad, see Andrew Peterson's contribution to this volume.

45 Ibn al-Fuwaṭī, *Talkhīṣ majma' al-ādāb*, ed. al-Kāẓim, IV.263-264.

Blessed History, in the years after he first wrote it.⁴⁶ Despite his modifications to the text, we have no evidence of Rashīd al-Dīn himself being involved in a collation of earlier versions as late as 1314, by which time his scholarly activities were focused on theology. However, the fact that several versions of the text existed by that point may have inspired scholars working in Baghdad to undertake a collation on their own initiative.

Exhibit C: The Khwāfī recension and the ghost colophon

The colophon at the end of the 1317 Baghdad manuscript is mirrored in a sub-recension of the *Blessed History* characterised by a set of additions made by Rashīd Khwāfī, father of the copyist of the Baghdad manuscript.⁴⁷ Khwāfī is known as the copyist of a manuscript of ‘Alā’ al-Dīn Juvaynī’s *History of the World Conqueror* (*Tārīkh-i jahān-gushā*) dated December 1290 (Paris, BnF, supp. pers. 205), and many of his additions to the *Blessed History* concern the lives of the Juvaynī brothers ‘Alā’ al-Dīn and the *ṣāhib diwān* Shams al-Dīn. In several places he signs his additions, referring to himself by name or as “the scribe of this blessed book” (*nāsukh-i in kitab-i mubārak*).

The version of the *Blessed History* that Rashīd Khwāfī modified was nearly identical to the copy made in Baghdad in 1317, and it is likely that father and son worked from the same source manuscript. It included the story of the abduction of Hambaqai Khan, which is mentioned above as one of the few differences between the Baghdad and Tashkent manuscripts. In fact, this story has survived only in the Baghdad manuscript and copies of the Khwāfī recension. However, Khwāfī’s exemplar also included several of the short passages of text found in the Tashkent copy that are missing from the Baghdad manuscript. It therefore was not copied directly from either manuscript, but probably shared an exemplar with the Baghdad manuscript and possibly also with the Tashkent manuscript.

Three copies of the Khwāfī recension survive. Two of these (Vienna, ÖNB, MS Mixt. 326; Oxford, Bodleian, MS Elliot 377) are from the 15th and 16th centuries, the latter dated 944 AH (1537-1538 CE). They share three large internal lacunae, but they each contain smaller lacunae not found in the other, suggesting a shared defective source. The third copy (London, BL, MS Add. 16688) seems to be very early, perhaps from the Ilkhanid period. It is remarkable, beyond its early date and its inclusion of Rashīd Khwāfī’s added notes, for the fact that it preserves a colophon based on the one also found in the Baghdad manuscript of 1317. As with that colophon, this one praises Rashīd al-Dīn, describes the structure of the *Collected Histories*, and then explains that the author has included the contents of the second volume at the end of the current manuscript for the benefit of those who do not have access to both. The colophon is followed by over three pages of text about the accession of Öljeitü, extending the text by nine lines more than the Baghdad manuscript.

Two significant changes have been made to this colophon when compared to the Baghdad manuscript. (The text of these colophon variants is included as an appendix at the end of this

46 Kamola, *Making Mongol History*, 121-153.

47 The “Khwāfī recension” is described by Kamola, *Making Mongol History*, 143-146, and catalogued at pp. 228-230 as the k recension.

article.) First, credit for including the history of Öljeitü is claimed by “Muḥammad b. Ḥamza, known as Rashīd Khwāfi, who is the scribe of this blessed book”. Second, this version of the colophon expands the description of the contents of the *Collected Histories* to include the gazetteer of the third volume. These changes seem to have been made at two separate times. The first undoubtedly belongs to Rashīd Khwāfi, who identifies himself by his signature phrase. The second change – the expansion of the description of the *Collected Histories* – is out of keeping with the rest of the colophon, which focuses on the relationship between the first and second volumes of the work. This change was probably made when the first and last pages of the manuscript were recopied by Muḥammad b. Abī Ṭāhir b. Ḥassan in October 1524 presumably because they had been damaged. In doing so, Muḥammad b. Abī Ṭāhir probably referred to the description of the *Collected Histories* found in the work’s general introduction, clumsily inserting the three-volume structure described there into a colophon otherwise concerned only with the first two volumes. It was probably also Muḥammad b. Abī Ṭāhir, then, who introduced other minor errors into the colophon as he recopied it.⁴⁸

Somehow, Rashīd Khwāfi’s version of the colophon without Muḥammad b. Abī Ṭāhir’s modification – taking credit for appending the history of Öljeitü’s accession but still describing the *Collected Histories* as a two-volume work – appears in the Aga Khan copy of the *Blessed History*. Strangely, neither this manuscript nor the manuscript in Tashkent from which it was copied contain Rashīd Khwāfi’s additions to the text. How the colophon in Rashīd Khwāfi’s name came to be added to the Aga Khan manuscript remains a mystery, especially since the end of the Tashkent manuscript is missing. However, it seems to be even more correct than what is found in the Baghdad manuscript, and may – with the exception of Rashīd Khwāfi’s arrogation of credit – accurately reflect the wording of a shared source, presumably the copy from which father and son made their copies at different times.

The Baghdad Ghāzāniyya as a centre of Rashīdī manuscript production

Bringing this evidence together, the most likely scenario to explain the formal similarities but textual variances between the Tashkent copy of the *Blessed History* and the manuscript copied in Baghdad in 1317 is that, in the last years of Rashīd al-Dīn’s life, the Ghāzāniyya complex in the north of Baghdad undertook a programme of reproducing his works inspired by his instructions in the endowment deed and influenced by a local effort to create a new collation of the extant versions. The Tashkent copy of the *Blessed History* may have been produced in Tabriz and sent to Baghdad to be used as an exemplar, in which case it was dispatched without any illustrations. More likely is that it was an early Baghdadi copy of an exemplar that has not survived, or perhaps a copy made in a different city from a different exemplar under very strict copy control.

In 1314 or 1315, when Ibn al-Fuwaṭī worked with Kamāl al-Dīn al-Ardabīlī on the collation of the *Collected Histories*, they may have inserted some new material, including the story of the abduction of Hambaqai Khan that does not seem to have made it into the copy now in Tashkent. However, as this collated version went into production, the workers of the

48 My thanks to Florian Schwarz for helping me tease apart the likely relationship between these colophons.

scriptorium made adjustments to the format of surrounding pages to keep the new copy in sync with its exemplar, whether that was the Tashkent manuscript itself or an unknown third manuscript. It may also have been at this point that the collation team in Baghdad created a new standard colophon for their edition. In it, they explain the inclusion of the brief history of Öljeitü's accession as an accommodation for the challenge of finding the full history of Öljeitü in the second volume (which may have never existed, after all!), not recognising that the table of contents of the *Collected Histories* actually calls for just such a short account of the accession (as a *tārīkh*, not a full *dāstān*). This standard colophon was left without a date or copyist's name, intended instead as a form to be filled in as copies were made. At some point, Rashīd Khwāfī copied this text, adding a series of anecdotes and reshaping the colophon to emphasise his role in preparing the text. In 1317, his son Mubārakshāh again copied the Baghdad exemplar, creating the manuscript now kept in Istanbul.

The presence of a Baghdad scriptorium producing a version of the *Collected Histories* edited by scholars outside of Rashīd al-Dīn's direct supervision also helps explain the state of the earliest Persian copy of the world history – also dated to 1317 – described above as having the same written dimensions as the Baghdad copy of the *Blessed History*. Those who have connected this manuscript (Istanbul, TSM, MS H.1654) to the Rashīdī quarter in Tabriz point to its few original images as evidence that it was incomplete at the time of Rashīd al-Dīn's death but somehow survived the sacking of the endowed district. If, based on its format, we instead attribute this manuscript to a regional scriptorium such as the Ghāzāniyya in Baghdad, then it would have had an easier time surviving the period of turmoil surrounding Rashīd al-Dīn's death. Even if the Baghdad scriptorium was part of Rashīd al-Dīn's madrasa, its incorporation into the larger complex associated with the late great Ghāzān Khān would have provided cover for it to survive the violence elsewhere visited on Rashīd al-Dīn's property.

This scenario might also explain another peculiarity of manuscript H.1654, which is missing the sections on the Salghurids and the Ismā'īlīs found in other copies of the world history but includes Rashīd al-Dīn's treatise against the philosophy of transubstantiation at the end of the section on India. Elsewhere I have speculated that Rashīd al-Dīn himself may have introduced these changes.⁴⁹ However, such an interpretation assumes that he continued editing the *Collected History* long after switching his intellectual work to theology. If instead manuscript H.1654 is the product of a scriptorium operating semi-independently of Rashīd al-Dīn, these changes may represent a local decision or circumstance. Indeed, the colophon on fol. 350a of H.1654 includes a note mentioning that a group of pages had been removed from the book. The fact that the colophon frame is formatted to include this note suggests that it already appeared in the source manuscript from which it was copied. It is likely, then, that an original Rashīdī manuscript, sent to Baghdad or another local scriptorium, lost the sections on the Salghurids and Ismā'īlīs – either by design or by accident – and then was copied in its altered form to create manuscript H.1654. Since the latter became one of the most copied manuscripts of the world history in later centuries, that decision has significantly shaped the reception of Rashīd al-Dīn's work.

49 Kamola, Salghurid history, 139-141.

At all phases of its early production, the *Collected Histories* of Rashīd al-Dīn was beset by a fundamental discrepancy between modification and standardisation. As he wrote the *Blessed History*, Rashīd al-Dīn included headers inviting additions of text as new information became available. However, later in his life he devised a strict reproduction scheme for copying his works and checking them against their exemplars. Even then, however, the work's evolution continued. Here we have revisited the evidence from manuscripts and other witnesses to suggest that a group of scholars, possibly including Ibn al-Fuwaṭī, Kamāl al-Dīn Ardabīlī, and the scribes Rashīd Khwāfī and his son, edited and altered the text in Baghdad, in the scriptorium of the Ghāzāniyya complex but away from the direct oversight of its supervisor Rashīd al-Dīn. The modifications to and interpretations of the text made in Baghdad in the decade after the *Collected Histories* was completed helped set the trajectory of its reception for the following seven centuries.

Appendix: Persian text of manuscript colophons

Below are three related colophons discussed in previous pages. They all seem to descend from a standardised colophon added to an exemplar of the text made in Baghdad, with spaces left for the specific date and name of copyist of copies made from it. The first is from the copy made in Baghdad in 1317 by Mubārakshāh b. Rashīd Khwāfī. The second reflects Rashīd Khwāfī's intervention, though it is inexplicably included at the end of a manuscript that does not include the additions he made to the text. The third is from a copy of Rashīd Khwāfī's sub-recension, with later modifications made by Muḥammad b. Abī Ṭāhir b. Ḥassan in October 1524.

Istanbul, Topkapı Saray Müzesi, MS R.1518, fol. 342b

مودخم جهانیان آصف عهد مصنف این کتاب که موسوم است به تاریخ مبارک غازانی به نام سلطان سعید مغفور
مرحوم غازان خان انارالله برهانه ساخته و به نام پادشاه وقت سلطان سلاطین الارض مشارقها و مغاربها مجلدی
دیگر ساخته است که موسوم است به تاریخ عالم و آن مجملی است از عهد آدم تا اکنون و تاریخ و حکایات این پادشاه
وقت که تا قیام ساعت پاینده و مستدام باد از ابتدای ولادت او تا منتها که جاوید خواهد بود ذیل آن کتاب باشد و اما
چون هر کس را دست رس آن نباشد که این هر دو مجلد با عظمت را بنویسد اگر آن را نویسند خود مصنف عز
نصره داخل آن کرده است و اگر کسی این مجلد نویسد و خواهد که داخل این کند یمن که بدین گستاخی ذیل عفو و
اغماض پوشانند.

تمام شد این کتاب مبارک در آخر ماه شعبان سنه سبع عشر و سبع مائه هلالیه به مقام بغداد حماها الله تعالی

The Lord of the Worlds, the Āṣif of the Age, the author of this book which is known as the *Blessed History of Ghāzān*, made it in the name of the late deceased lord Sultan Ghāzān Khān – may God illuminate his memory. And a second volume was made in the name of the current Pādishāh, the Sultan of Sultans of the world east and west, which is known as the *World History* and which is a compendium from the time of Adam until now. And the history and account of this current Pādishāh – may he be lasting and constant until the coming of the final hour – from the beginning of his birth to the favours of his immortality, was an addendum [*dhayl*] to that book. But as that which is written in these two great volumes is not available to everyone, if they should copy it themselves, the author – may his victory be glorious – has included that [*dākhel-e ān karde*], and if someone should copy this volume and should want to include this [*dākhel-e in konad*], may they cover this hubris with an addendum [*dhayl*] of forgiveness and tolerance.

This blessed book was finished at the end of the month of Sha'bān, in the lunar year 717 in Baghdad, may God Almighty protect her.

Toronto, Aga Khan Museum, MS AKM 517, fol. 344b

مخدوم جهانیان آصف عهد مصنف این کتاب که موسوم است بتاریخ مبارک غازانی عصر بنام سلطان سعید مغفور مرحوم غازان خان انارالله برهانه ساخته و بنام پادشاه وقت سلطان سلاطین الارض مشارقها و مغاربها مجلدی دیگر ساخته است که موسومست بتاریخ عالم و آن مجملیست از عهد آدم تا اکنون و تاریخ و حکایات این پادشاه وقت که تا قیام ساعت پاینده و مستدام باد از ابتدای ولادت او تا منتها که جاوید خواهد بود ذیل آن کتاب باشد و اما چون هر کس را دست رس آن نباشد که این هر دو مجلد با عظمت را بنویسد اگر آن را نویسند خود مصنف عز نصره داخل آن کرده است و اگر کسی این مجلد نویسد و خواهد که داخل این کند یمکن که بدین گستاخی ذیل عفو و اغماض پوشانند.

این بنده دولت محمد بن حمزه معروف برشید خوافی که ناسخ این کتاب مبارکست آنرا ذیل این کتاب خواهد ساخت بعد ازین نوشته شود انشاءالله تعالی

The Lord of the Worlds, the Āṣif of the Age, the author of this book which is known as the *Blessed History of Ghāzān* – may his victory be glorious – made it in the name of the late deceased lord Sultan Ghāzān Khān – may God illuminate his memory. And a second volume was made in the name of the current Pādishāh, the Sultan of Sultans of the world east and west, which is known as the *World History* and which is a compendium from the time of Adam until now. And the history and account of this current Pādishāh, may he be perpetual until the arrival of the final hour, from the beginning of his birth to the favours of his immortality, was an addendum to that book. But as that which is written in these two great volumes is not available to everyone, if they should copy it themselves, the author – may his victory be glorious – has included it, and if someone should copy this volume and should want to include this, may they forgive and tolerate this hubris.

This servant of the state, Muḥammad b. Ḥamza, known as Rashid Khwāfi, who is the writer of this blessed book, will attach that addendum after this is written, *inshā' allāh*.

London, British Library, MS Add. 16688, fol. 291a-b

مخدوم جهانیان آصف عهد مصنف این کتاب مبارک عز نصره که موسوم است بتاریخ مبارک غازانی این مجلد را بنام سلطان سعید مغفور مرحوم غازان خان انارالله برهانه ساخته و بنام پادشاه وقت سلطان سعید ظل الله تعالی سلطان الجایتو خلد ملکه مجلدی دیگر ساخته است که موسوم است بتاریخ عالم و آن مجملیست از عهد آدم تا اکنون و تاریخ و حکایات این پادشاه وقت از ابتدای ولادت او تا منتها که خواهد بود یک تاریخ عالم باشد. و آن خود مجلدی تمام چون بغایت با عظمتست هر کسی را دست رس آن نه که این سه مجلد جامع التواریخ را بنویسد. و اسامی مجلد ان اینس

اول	دوم	سیوم
ین تاریخ مبارک غازانی	تاریخ عالم بنام اولجایتو سلطان	صور الاقالیم و مالک الممالک و مسافات

اگر کسی خواهد که تاریخ عالم نویسد خود تاریخ اولجایتو سلطان داخل است و اگر کسی این مجلد نویسد اگر خواهد پادشاهی اولجایتو سلطان و هر که بعد از و باشد ذیل این می توان کرد این بنده دولت محمد بن حمزه معروف برشید خوافی که ناسخ این کتاب مبارکست آنرا ذیل این کتاب خواهد ساخت یمکن که بدین کستاخی عفو فرماید و آن بعد ازین نوشته شود ان شاءالله تعالی تمام شد تا غایه اخر عهد سلطان اسلام سعید مغفور مرحوم غازان خان طاب ثره والله اعلم

The Lord of the Worlds, the Āṣif of the Age, the author of this blessed book – may his victory be glorious – which is known as the *Blessed History of Ghāzān*, made this volume in the name of the late deceased lord Sultan Ghāzān Khān – may God illuminate his memory, and another volume in the name of the current Pādishāh, the shadow of God Almighty, Sultan Öljeitü – may his reign be perpetual – which is known as the *World History* and which is a compendium from the time of Adam until now and the history and account of this current Pādishāh, from the beginning of his birth to what will come would be as one history of the world. And since that complete volume by itself is so great, it is not available to everyone who might copy this three-volume *Collected Histories*. And the names of its volumes are as follows:

First	Second	Third
This <i>Blessed History of Ghāzān</i>	The <i>History of the World</i> in the name of Öljeitü Sultan	The <i>Image of the World and Routes of Kingdoms and Distances</i>

If someone wants to copy the world history, the history of Öljeitü Sultan is included, and if someone who copies this volume wants to be able to include here the Pādishāh Öljeitü Sultan and everything after him, this servant of the state, Muḥammad b. Ḥamza, known as Rashīd Khwāfī, who is the writer of this blessed book, will attach that *dhayl*, may he forgive and tolerate this hubris, and it will be written after this, *inshā 'allāh ta'ālā*. It was completed up to the end of the time of the Sultan of Islam, the late deceased lord Ghāzān Khān, may he rest in peace. And God knows best.

Acknowledgements

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List of figures

Figure 1. Hypothetical reconstruction of the opening folios of the *Blessed History*

Figure 2. Reconstructed foliation of prototype Ẓ-recension manuscript